



FUNDING PROPOSAL

HOME PORT: YEAR-ROUND PIER MOORAGE PARTNERSHIP

Three years alongside a public pier, with the shore power and gangway to open the ship to visitors every week.

\$510,000

TOTAL REQUEST

Executive summary

The Foundation seeks a multi-year berth at a public or partner marina pier, together with the one-time shore-side improvements that turn a moored ship into a working museum: shore-power connection, an accessible gangway and brow, fendering, security lighting and interpretive signage. Funding covers three years of moorage and utilities so the Foundation can commit to a weekly public schedule and build the visitor and volunteer base that sustains the ship long term.

Statement of need

A historic vessel at anchor cannot receive the public. Every hour of volunteer labor and every visitor requires a pier. Comanche has repeatedly demonstrated her draw — more than 5,000 visitors in two weeks at Olympia Harbor Days — but that demand cannot be served without a stable, accessible berth. Pier moorage for a 133.4-foot vessel runs roughly \$250 per day before utilities, beyond the reach of an all-volunteer organization without a partner.

Project description

Working with a host port or marina, the Foundation will (1) install or upgrade a 100 A shore-power connection with transformer and cable; (2) fabricate and install an accessible aluminum gangway and brow with handrails, plus fendering to protect both pier and hull; (3) add security lighting and cameras at the berth; (4) install interpretive panels on the pier so the ship teaches even when closed; and (5) fund three years of moorage, utilities and liability coverage. In return the host receives a landmark attraction, a weekly open-ship program, school and youth visits, and a volunteer-maintained historic vessel on its waterfront.

Goals & measurable objectives

- Executed multi-year berth agreement with a host port or marina.
- Shore power, gangway, fendering and lighting installed and inspected.
- Weekly public open-ship hours published and held (target 40+ days/year).

- 2,500+ visitors and 150+ youth-program participants per year at the berth.
- Interpretive panels installed and accessible without boarding.

Timeline

Months 1–3	Host agreement, berth engineering review, permits for pier-side work.
Months 3–6	Shore power, gangway, fendering and lighting installed.
Month 6	Vessel in berth; public schedule launched.
Years 1–3	Programs delivered; annual report to funder and host.

Budget

Moorage, 133 ft, 36 months	\$158,000
Utilities: shore power, water, pump-out, 36 months	\$36,000
Shore-power pedestal upgrade, transformer, cable and connection	\$48,000
Accessible gangway, brow, float, handrails and fendering	\$65,000
Security lighting and cameras at berth	\$14,000
Interpretive signage on the pier (design, fabrication, install)	\$18,000
Marina liability coverage rider, 36 months	\$36,000
Berth engineering review and permits	\$12,000
Direct costs	\$387,000
Project management & administration (8%)	\$30,960
Contingency (20%)	\$83,592
Total project cost	\$501,552
Amount requested (rounded)	\$510,000

Budget lines are order-of-magnitude planning figures for a 133.4 ft / 295 GT steel vessel on Puget Sound, deliberately conservative so the funded scope can be delivered in full; they are replaced with vendor quotes at application. Unused contingency is returned or reallocated with funder approval. Partial funding is welcome and combinable with other sources.

In-kind and match. All docent, maintenance and program labor is volunteer (est. 4,000 hours/year); the host port's in-kind contribution (reduced moorage rate, staff time) is negotiated and counted as match.

Evaluation

- Berth agreement executed; improvements inspected and accepted by host.
- Visitor and volunteer counts logged per open-ship day.
- Partner and school feedback letters.

Funder fit

- Port districts and municipal waterfront programs
- Maritime Washington NHA
- 4Culture Heritage / Historic Preservation
- Corporate sponsors (maritime, tourism)
- Community foundations in the host city

- Annual cost and attendance report to the funder.

Sustainability

Three funded years let the Foundation build a membership and sponsorship base sized to carry moorage thereafter; the shore-side improvements remain with the host port as a permanent asset.

Organization overview

Tug Comanche Historical Rescue Foundation (EIN 39-5018917) is a Washington nonprofit based in Auburn, Washington, listed on the IRS Publication 78 data list as eligible to receive tax-deductible charitable contributions (deductibility code PC). The Foundation preserves the historic vessel Comanche — laid down in 1944 as the U.S. Navy ocean tug ATA-202, later USS Wampanoag and Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 — and operates her as a living platform for maritime heritage, hands-on education, youth mentorship, restoration-skills exposure, veteran and mariner storytelling, Puget Sound stewardship, and community service. Comanche is one of the last operational WWII museum ships in the world, still moving under her own power with an all-volunteer crew. The organization is governed by a volunteer board of directors and delivers its programs through volunteers, maritime-trades mentors and community partners.

Vessel history & significance

Comanche is a rare surviving example of a WWII-era U.S. Navy auxiliary ocean tug. Completed in 1944 and commissioned as ATA-202, she was named USS Wampanoag in 1948 and later served as the U.S. Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 before becoming known as Comanche. Her current U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Documentation (Official Number 647250; IMO 8991786) records a steel-hulled, mechanically propelled vessel of 133.4 feet registered length, 33.1-foot breadth, 17.7-foot depth, 295 gross tons and 200 net tons (ITC), hailing port Seattle, Washington. She is propelled by two Cleveland Diesel 12-cylinder diesel-electric main engines driving a single screw, and holds a world record as the last ship still steered by deck-tube chain rudder control.

Legal & operating boundary. Comanche does not hold a U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Inspection for commercial passenger service. No grant funds, fees or donations are or will be used for paid carriage, charters, towing, freight or any underway commercial service. Public programs take place alongside the pier; cruises occur only in partnership with other nonprofit and community organizations, never as a charter, and the Foundation retains control of the vessel at all times.

Contact: Wesley Weaver, Secretary — info@tug202.org — tug202.org · The web version of this proposal, with the latest figures, is at tug202.org/grants/home-port-partnership.